

AABW · HO CHI MINH CITY · JUL 8–12, 2026

Hackathon Submission Playbook

Do's, don'ts, and what judges are looking for at Agentic AI Build Week — so your team submits with confidence.

GenAI Fund · Agentic AI Build Week 2026

HOW YOU'RE SCORED

What Judges Look For

Agentic AI Use

Planning, reasoning, tool use, workflow execution, or multi-step autonomous action — not a single prompt-response wrapper.

Technical Execution

The project is functional, technically credible, and shows thoughtful implementation.

Creativity

Novel, differentiated, or an original approach to the problem.

Problem / Track Fit

The project clearly addresses the selected track and its real enterprise problem statement.

Impact / Usefulness

Clear value for real users, teams, organizations, or communities.

Pitch / Demo Clarity

The team communicates problem, solution, and value clearly inside the time box.

Do This

01

Build one project per track when possible. If your project is genuinely relevant to more than one track, you may submit it to each — but every individual submission must be assigned to exactly one track.

02

Show planning and tool use, not just output. Agentic AI Use is what judges look for first — make your reasoning and multi-step action visible.

03

Have a working demo, tested live. Technical execution is judged in the room — rehearse the exact flow you'll show.

04

Submit through the AABW event portal. Not Devpost — fill in every required hackathon submission field completely.

05

Confirm your track by Jul 11, 3:00 PM. No confirmation on the event portal by then means no eligibility for judging.

06

Submit by Jul 12, 9:00 AM — and check in in person. At least one team representative must check in on-site to confirm your team is pitching.

Avoid This

01

Don't enter a track that isn't genuinely relevant. You can submit the same project to more than one track if it truly fits each one — but forcing an unrelated track hurts your Problem/Track Fit.

02

Don't wrap a single API call and call it "agentic." Judges are specifically looking for planning, reasoning, and multi-step action.

03

Don't run over your pitch time. Round 1 is 8 minutes total (5 pitch + 2 Q&A + 1 transition), Round 2 is 12. Timekeeping is strict.

04

Don't lead with your tech stack. Open with the problem and the "aha" moment, not architecture.

05

Don't wait until judging day to test your demo. Live failures are visible and directly hurt Technical Execution.

06

Don't leave fields blank or unchecked. Double-check every field in the event portal — description, track, tools used, team info — is complete and accurate before Jul 12, 9:00 AM.

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

FAQ

What makes a strong submission?

A clear one-line problem statement, a working live demo (not just slides), and an accurate list of every AI tool, model, and partner credit you used.

Where do I submit?

The AABW event portal. Devpost is no longer used for this event.

Can I submit the same project to more than one track?

Yes, if it's genuinely relevant to each track. It's not recommended to enter a track your project doesn't truly fit.

What's the most common submission mistake?

Leaving required fields blank or entering inaccurate information — description, team list, tools used, and track selection all need to be complete and correct.

Do I need to be there in person?

Yes. At least one team representative must check in on-site on Jul 12 to confirm your team is pitching.

Why does it matter which tools I record?

Several tech partners run bonus prizes on top of track prizes — recording and correctly selecting the tools you used is what makes you eligible for those.

Can we get real data from our enterprise partner?

We're chasing it, but if it isn't in hand by end of day today, it's probably not coming. Plan to build with synthetic data instead. If your idea can't work with synthetic data, drop that part of the idea rather than wait on the data.

Remaining Best Practices

- 1 **State the problem in one sentence before the solution.** Make your Problem/Track Fit unmissable from the first line of your pitch.
- 2 **Build for the actual enterprise brief, not a hypothetical.** AABW tracks are grounded in real problem statements from partners like AWS, Vietjet, Tasco, and KFC Vietnam — solve the brief that's given.
- 3 **Record a backup demo video.** Wifi and API hiccups happen inside your pitch window — a fallback protects your Technical Execution.
- 4 **Record every tool and tech partner you use — accurately.** Several tech partners run bonus prizes on top of track prizes, so select your tools correctly in the submission portal to be considered.
- 5 **Disclose any pre-existing code or assets.** Using something you built before AABW is fine — not disclosing it is not.
- 6 **Assign one team member to own the pitch.** A single confident narrator communicates more clearly than a group hand-off.
- 7 **Treat Demo Day as a pilot conversation.** Enterprise partners are in the room to find teams to work with after judging — not just to hand out trophies.

Team Setup & Project Overview

Team Name

Keep it consistent with your project branding — it appears on your public profile and Demo Day materials.

Invite Teammates

Add every teammate before the roster locks. Only the team captain can edit it afterward.

Choose Tracks

Select only the track(s) your project genuinely fits — problem statements are locked to whichever tracks you choose here.

Selected Problem Statement

Pick the exact problem statement your build addresses — it's the direct anchor for your Problem/Track Fit.

Project Title

Make it descriptive and memorable, not clever-but-vague. It's the first thing judges and the public gallery see.

Elevator Pitch

One or two plain-language sentences on what it does and who it's for — your project's first impression.

The Project Story Field

"About the project" is the field judges read most closely. Structure it with these sections:

- 1 **Inspiration.** What real problem or moment sparked this build? Ground it in something specific, not generic.
- 2 **What it does.** Describe the product in plain language before any technical detail.
- 3 **How you built it.** Name your actual architecture and tools — this is where Technical Execution gets judged.
- 4 **Challenges you ran into.** Be honest about what was hard and how you solved it — judges read this as a signal of depth.
- 5 **Accomplishments you're proud of.** Pick one concrete moment or result, not a generic superlative.
- 6 **What you learned.** A real insight, not a platitude.
- 7 **What's next.** Show you're thinking past the hackathon — this feeds Impact/Usefulness.
- + **Built With (tags).** List every tool, framework, platform, database, API, or model by its exact name — it feeds directly into how Agentic AI Use and Technical Execution are read.

Links, Media & Partner Tools

Demo URL

Test it in an incognito window right before you submit — a broken or gated link costs you Technical Execution points live.

GitHub / Repository URL

Make sure it's public (or judge-accessible) and the README explains how to run it.

Image Gallery

Upload 3–5 screenshots of the actual product in use, 3:2 ratio, readable at a glance.

Video Demo Link

Keep it to 2–3 minutes and show the product working — don't narrate over slides.

AABW Technology Partner Tools

Select every partner tool you genuinely used — this is what makes you eligible for that partner's bonus prizes.

Explain Partner Tool Usage

Be specific about what each tool actually did in your build. Vague answers risk losing bonus-prize eligibility.

Before You Hit Submit

- 1 **Official Rules checkbox (required).** Read it before you check it — every team member is bound by it once submitted.
- 2 **Public visibility checkbox.** Check it if you want your project visible on builder profiles and the public gallery — leave unchecked only if you have a specific reason not to.
- 3 **In-person check-in.** At least one teammate must physically check in on Jul 12. Absent teams risk disqualification even with a fully complete submission.
- 4 **Final submission check.** Review the team and track/problem-statement summary shown on this step before confirming — your last chance to catch a wrong track or missing field.

USE THIS AS YOUR CHECKLIST

Every field above maps 1:1 to the actual AABW submission portal — work through it top to bottom as you fill out your entry.

DON'T MISS THESE

Key Dates

Jul 11, 3:00 PM

Track confirmation deadline on the event portal

Jul 11

Building Day

Jul 12, 9:00 AM

Submission deadline on the event portal — at least one team representative must check in in person

Jul 12, 10:00 AM

Judging Day begins — Round 1 → Round 2 → Awards (4:00 PM)

BOTTOM LINE

Build for one track, submit complete and accurate info on the event portal, record every tool you use, and show up in person to pitch.